Diagnose Before Solving: Lead-in Training Outline (Pre-Simulation)

Abbreviated lead-in, v0.4

Project owner: David Bacon
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Document status: Revised for publication
Related: Scope Document 4.1, Embedding and LMS Readiness Note section 5 (the teaching principles still apply), Decision Log Part 2 (D-146 to D-172) and Part 3 (D-173 onward)

Revision note (v0.3). The training is no longer a Storyline module. It is a static web page built in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript and hosted on GitHub Pages, with a link to the simulation at the end (D-173, D-177). The content decisions in this outline are unchanged; the delivery mechanics are rewritten. The filename still says "storyline" so that references to it elsewhere in the project, including the decision logs, keep working (D-186).

Revision note (v0.4). The one open design question, whether "Start the call" suppresses the simulation's landing view with `?embed=1`, was resolved by D-190 and is now stated as settled in sections 2, 4 and 7. No slide content changed.

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1. Purpose and scope

The simulation is the assessment. It needs a short lead-in so a learner arrives knowing what a good call looks like, and so a portfolio visitor can see that the simulation is one component of a designed experience (Scope 4.1).

This outline covers **six slides, roughly eight to ten minutes**, followed by a link to the simulation. It is deliberately not the full course. The aim is to ship the lead-in without delaying deployment, and to leave a clear path for expanding it later (section 6).

This document does not touch the simulation. No application code, prompts, rubric, or fixtures are built or changed by it.

2. Constraints inherited from the project

Constraint	Source	What it means for the slides
The rubric is never shown before the call	D-055	Teach the moves in plain language; do not present a five-item checklist or mention points
Teach before, do not remind during	Integration Note section 5	Nothing between the lessons and the call beyond a short framing line (slide 6)
The root cause must stay the learner's discovery	D-029	Training examples come from **other domains**; the CRM scenario is never used or hinted at
Acknowledge-and-pivot reads as a technique	D-041, D-048	The acknowledgment slide must teach the difference between a sentence that leads somewhere and one that sets up a "but"
Promise contact, not outcomes	D-051	The commitment slide states plainly what is within a specialist's control
Each activity must be finished before moving on	D-173, Storyboard section 1	On slides 2 to 5 the Next button stays hidden until the slide's activity is complete. The lead-in does not gate the simulation, since the two are separate sites (D-177)
The simulation has its own landing view that sets the scenario for a visitor who arrives directly	D-016, Scope 4.1, D-190	Slide 6 does that job for a learner who arrives from the lead-in. The "Start the call" link carries `?embed=1`, which suppresses the landing view so the learner does not meet the scenario twice (D-190). A visitor who opens the simulation directly still gets the landing view

3. Audience and objectives

Audience: junior-to-mid internal tech support specialists (Scope 2.2).

By the end of this lead-in, the learner can:

1. Open a heated call by acknowledging the person and what is at stake for them before troubleshooting.
2. Ask open-ended questions about what people experience at the point of work, in order to find a cause.
3. Distinguish a software defect, a training gap, and a workflow mismatch, and say which one the evidence points to.
4. Route the problem to whoever can fix it, and commit to what the specialist controls: who will follow up, and when.

These map to the simulation's skills without mirroring the rubric's wording, so the learner is prepared rather than coached to a checklist.

4. Slide-by-slide outline

Slide 1: Your next call

- **Purpose:** set the role, the format, and the expectation.
- **On screen:** you are an internal tech support specialist; a caller is waiting; this short lead-in, then a live practice call in text, then feedback; retries are allowed.
- **Includes:** the four objectives in learner language ("by the end you will be able to...").
- **Interaction:** Next, plus a skip button that jumps to slide 6, "Before you pick up" (D-162).

Slide 2: A symptom is not a cause

- **Purpose:** establish the core principle with minimal text.
- **On screen:** a fix applied to a symptom costs three things: time, trust, and the real problem keeps going.
- **Then the three kinds of cause,** presented with equal weight: a software defect, a training gap, a workflow mismatch. One line each, plus a clue that points toward it.
- **Interaction:** sort three short cases into the three categories. Use varied domains (a printer queue that drops jobs, a new-hire portal nobody was shown how to use, a clinic check-in kiosk placed where patients do not walk; see D-168 for why this replaced a scheduling-tool example). Feedback explains the clue that decided each one.
- **Design note:** each category must be the right answer at least once, so no category reads as "the usual one."

Slide 3: Move one, acknowledge before you troubleshoot

- **Purpose:** teach acknowledgment of the person and the stake.
- **On screen:** two openings to the same angry call, shown side by side as what the caller hears.
- **Teaching point:** acknowledgment that leads into a real question or commitment lands; acknowledgment followed by "but, I need a ticket number" reads as a technique.
- **Interaction:** select each opening to reveal the caller's likely reaction.
- **Design note:** the example call is a different industry and a different complaint from the simulation.

Slide 4: Move two, ask to find the cause

- **Purpose:** teach open questions about the experience at the point of work.
- **On screen:** closed questions confirm what you already believe; open questions about what people do and see at the moment things go wrong surface what you did not know.
- **Interaction:** for three pairs, pick the question that would reveal more. Short feedback on each.
- **Teaching point:** order matters. A person who does not feel heard will not hand over detail.

Slide 5: Move three, say what you found, route it, commit to what you control

- **Purpose:** teach reflection, escalation, and an honest commitment.
- **On screen:** state the cause back and check it; name who can actually fix it; tell the caller who will follow up and when, without being asked.

- **Teaching points:**
  - "It is working as designed" and "that is a training issue" are conclusions, not diagnoses, and callers who have heard them before hear a brush-off.
  - You can promise a call on Thursday with an update. You cannot promise the fix by Thursday.
- **Interaction:** a short ordering activity; keep it low-effort.

Slide 6: Before you pick up

- **Purpose:** the bridge to the call, and the context note for anyone who skipped the lessons.
- **On screen:** the caller is a regional sales lead in the middle of a bad month; it is a text conversation treated as a live call; there is no checklist on screen, just as there is none on a real call; you will get detailed feedback afterward and can try again.
- **Does not include:** the rubric, the point values, or any hint about the cause. It does name and define the CRM (D-166), since the simulation's first line names it and the simulation does not define it; it says nothing about what has changed or gone wrong in that tool.
- **Interaction:** a "Start the call" link to the simulation. This is also where the skip button from slide 1 lands, so it must make sense to a viewer who has seen none of slides 2 to 5: it states the role, the caller, and the format in a few lines.

Hand-off to the simulation

A plain link to the simulation's production address with `?embed=1`, so the call starts without the landing view (D-190). The address is set in one place in the page (D-182). Nothing is passed between the two sites: no score, no completion flag, no learner data. The lead-in cannot tell whether the learner finished the call, and it does not need to (D-177).

Debrief slide: not built

The optional debrief (score, pass or fail branch, retry) needed data from the simulation, which two separate sites do not share. The simulation's own results view carries the score and detailed feedback, so nothing learner-facing is lost (D-183).

5. Build notes

- **Built as:** one HTML page, one stylesheet, one script, plus a README; no framework, no build step, no dependencies, hosted on GitHub Pages (D-179). The slide copy is taken from the storyboard (D-180).
- **Layout:** responsive, one column on a phone. The Storyline story size recommendation (1280 by 720, Scope 6.3) no longer applies to the lead-in (D-186).
- **State:** nothing is stored in the browser and nothing is sent anywhere. No slide is tracked (D-162, D-179).
- **Skip button (D-158):** a button on the opening slide jumps to slide 6 for viewers who only want the call, so they get the call's framing without the teaching slides (D-162). Each slide also has its own address (`#/1` to `#/6`), so linking to slide 6 directly does the same thing.
- **Accessibility:** the baseline from Scope section 7 applies to the lead-in too: keyboard operable (dragging is an extra, never a requirement; D-181), no color-only feedback, focus moved to each slide's heading, reduced motion respected. Tested in Chrome only; see D-184 for what was and was not verified.

6. Deliberately left out, and the expansion path

Left out to protect the deployment date: worked examples with narrated video or audio, branching practice scenarios, a job aid or quick-reference card, a second practice call, a debrief tied to the learner's score (D-183), and a module-level assessment independent of the simulation.

If the full course is built later, the natural order is: add one branching practice scenario between slides 5 and 6, restore a short quick check (cut for time in D-162; completion tracking would now need somewhere to store results, since the site stores nothing), add a downloadable job aid, and expand slide 2 into a short case-based lesson on telling the three causes apart.

If the lead-in is later merged into the simulation's own application (Option B in D-174), the site is a self-contained folder and can be moved without a rewrite.

7. Resolved and open questions

Storyboard: the slide-by-slide copy, interactions, glossary, and acronym audit are in `claude/storyline-storyboard.md` (D-165), revised for the web build in v0.2 and v0.3.

Resolved (October 23, 2026):

- The slide 6 quick check was added, then cut (D-157, reversed by D-162). The lead-in is six slides.
- Ten minutes was an acceptable length (D-159); six slides runs somewhat shorter.
- The skip button lands on slide 6, "Before you pick up," so a viewer who skips still gets the call's framing (D-158, refined by D-162).
- Module completion depends on the simulation alone, since no lead-in slide is tracked (D-161, resolved by D-162).
- This outline is filed with the project documents (D-156, D-160).
- The outline is to be linked from the portfolio page alongside the other project documents (D-164).

Resolved (November 11, 2026):

- The lead-in is built as a static site, not in Storyline (D-173), hosted on GitHub Pages and linked to the simulation (D-177).
- No debrief slide (D-183).
- The "Start the call" link carries `?embed=1`, so a learner who has just read slide 6 does not meet the scenario a second time (D-190, resolving D-182).

Open:

1. The published address of the training site, once the repository exists (D-185). The link on the portfolio page (D-164) should point to it.